

**Regular Meeting
Monday, February 11, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, and High School Representative Chioma Opara.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Mayor Burke called meeting to order at 7:03pm.

7 - Present

Ms. DiBenedetto

Ms. Kreatz

Ms. Mustone

Mr. Ruggiero

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Mayor Burke

0 - Absent

Approval of Minutes of February 4, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote - 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion passes.

Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.

Roll Call Vote - 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion passes.

Motion to suspend the rules to have Jingle Bell Run funds distribution offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, rules suspended.

Jingle Bell Road Race Funds Distribution - Judy Lonergan - We have 30 checks to distribute. St. Joseph's School. St. Raphael's School. Medford Rowing. Columbus School. Andrews Middle School. Asian Club. McGlynn Middle School. McGlynn Elementary. Roberts Elementary. Most

funds raised and most participants from Roberts. Total money raised was \$31,809. Mayor Burke - Thanks to all involved. Ms. DiBenedetto - Thanks to Judy Lonergan. Ms. Lonergan - With the Jingle Bell festival as well we raised \$54,000. It takes a village. We are looking for more volunteers.

Recognition of Columbus Elementary Student Writers - Chibudom Ezoni, Izmonde Pelitfrene, Patricia Castillo, Kristin Morris, and Eliot Anglese who couldn't be with us. Spooky Sagas is scheduled to be published in March. Congratulations to our young writers! Ms. Van der Kloot - The members received your stories and we enjoyed reading them. Motion to approve report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Recognition of Arden Ingersoll and Katharine Schmidt for Accomplishments in Music Performance - Tony Szygniej - Katharine Schmidt was selected to the MMEA Junior Festival. Return appearance by Arden Ingersoll, who was here a few weeks ago. Arden will be performing in Symphony Hall as part of the All-State Conference.

Motion to table Agenda Item VIII.4 offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes. Recognition of Tristen Howard will take place at the March 4 meeting.

Recognitions of the Contributions of the Class of 1965 - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Sharon Deyeso - Thank you very much to the Mayor and the new Superintendent. It's a pleasure to be here tonight, it was a surprise. We noticed more needy kids in Medford than when we were in school. We decided that each year we will have a brunch and we will use funds we raise to start a book bag and bus passes fund. Our brunch will be in the fall, we have wonderful people who attend and we are very interested in our students. We are hoping to continue as long as I'm alive. Motion to approve report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Ms. Van der Kloot - I would like to bring an issue up while we are under suspension. Ms. Patterson recommended that we look into bringing the budget to the Personnel Sub Committee. All members would be welcome and encouraged to attend the Sub Committee meeting. Ms. Patterson - In the interest of transparency and going deeper into conversation around budgeting, building understanding and consensus, if we present in a Sub Committee format we can make sure there is deep understanding. We are hopeful we can get support in this new format to have some honest good discussions and open, transparent communications. Mr. Ruggiero - How many times would you expect to meet? Ms. Patterson - 6 sub committee meetings. Mr. Ruggiero - I would prefer it to be Committee of the Whole. Mayor Burke - This isn't on our agenda. I think it should be tabled. Motion to table offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Motion passes. It will be on the March 4 agenda.

Motion to return to regular agenda offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report of Committees - Support Services Sub Committee - Mr. Ruseau - Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We have a video to summarize our math learning walks that we conducted at the elementary schools. It looks different from the first pass of math learning walks because we dug deeper into the visits. I'm very appreciative to Jack for making this video and showing the discussions. I hope this video gave you a better perspective on the math walks. I would welcome you all to participate in the walks in the spring. We now have a common language. Ms. Van der Kloot - I attended the math learning walks and found it to be a wonderful opportunity to witness the work on instruction. I encourage the rest of the school committee to attend. Ms. DiBenedetto - After the second walk did you notice if every school is learning the same things across the district? Is there consistency? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, one comment made by Bernadette Ricciardelli, even with teachers with different styles, the same content is being taught. Patricia Crain de Gallarce has observed great improvement in the classrooms even from September. We were happy to see intentional practice and attention given to mathematics. Ms. DiBenedetto - I noticed the EL Director. Were our Special Education people there? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We observed inclusion rooms. Not everyone's schedule for the second round was able to work, but the idea is to scale it up. Our EL Director was there because EL students also take math. The idea is for everyone to observe. Mr. Ruseau - How were classrooms selected? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We had our math coaches focus on grades 3, 4, and 5. For the learning walks we had 4 groups, large groups, so we observed 16 classrooms. Sometimes we were also able to observe math in Kindergarten, 1st grade, and 2nd grade. Each round was 15 minutes long. Every classroom is observed. Mr. Ruseau - I would just want to make sure that principals wouldn't be selecting classes to observe where they would expect the best outcomes. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Every classroom is observed.

One of our students at the Andrews met Master Chef Lion. Daniel Pontes-Macedo or Master Chef Lion grew up in Medford and when a local fan asked for a signed picture, he came to her house and gave her a cooking lesson.

There is no February vacation camp this year, but the McGlynn Middle School will have a volleyball camp and there will be extended skating hours at LoConte rink during February break.

9th grade course selection night was a packed house. They gave a wonderful presentation. A parent wrote an email applauding the merger of MHS and MVTHS. Congratulations to the team.

Vaping presentation was held on Thursday night. Parents attended. Tobacco-free community partnership. Parents were able to witness how children may hide nicotine products. It was a good presentation and should be repeated throughout the district.

Mustang news: Last week we mentioned Tristen Howard won the Northeast Conference title for track. This week he came in second place in the state finals and qualified for nationals and will be traveling to Chicago in March.

Professional culture training: Last Wednesday we had training with staff and middle/high school teachers, 2 weeks before that we hosted the training for administrators in the district. It discussed sexual harassment and bullying in the workplace. It was well-attended and the educators participated well.

On Friday we had two evacuations at Medford High School. Due to an electrical issue and a transformer issue, we had to evacuate twice, out of an abundance of caution. Building principals make the call when incidents like this occur. We advise parents to listen to robo-calls from the building administrator or read posts on our blog, twitter, or website. Special thanks to all members of staff who work together to keep students safe. A big thank you to students who were very cooperative and paid attention to instructions. They acted like true Mustangs.

A reminder to all in town, fire lanes around buildings are not for parking. Medford Police will be randomly patrolling the schools and will ticket people who park there. It is a safety issue.

On Saturday we had the Medford Family Network annual Valentine's Day festival. A great time was had by all. Thanks to all the members of the School Committee for attending, as well as Rick Caraviello, George Scarpelli, Joe Falco, Breanna Lungo-Koehn, and Representative Paul Donato. It was a love fest. Thanks to Marie Cassidy, her heart is as big as this room.

Friday evening I attended the West Medford Community Center's Black History Month kick-off. Paul Ruseau was also there. It was a great event.

I want to make a brief announcement. There is some inclement weather coming our way. In preparation for that, we are not having afternoon events at the school. The enrichment program will not take place at the Andrews and McGlynn, no late buses. We will continue to send notifications via phone calls, blog, and website.

Happy Valentine's Day, Happy President's Day, have a restful vacation and I look forward to seeing you all in early March.

Motion that technology use policy be sent to the Rules Sub Committee by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Mayor Burke - At 3:00 this Saturday at LoConte Rink we will be paying tribute to Mr. Welch. We will unveil a plaque in his name.

Report on 5th to 6th Grade Transition - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - As I present to you this proposal, I am using my guiding principles of ACE - Achievement for all, Collaboration for all, Equity for all. In the spirit of equity, a cohort model is being implemented. There will be a lottery and 50% of students will be randomly selected from each 5th grade class. Half will go to the Andrews and half will go to the McGlynn. There will be an accommodation for sibling preference. If there is an educational service required that is only offered at one school, those needs will be accommodated. At the McGlynn, 60% of students are economically disadvantaged. At the Andrews it is only 29%. The lottery system will be a fair and unbiased process.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I think this is a fair way to make sure that both schools have equal opportunity for all students. I support this idea. We also discussed the Superintendent's idea that one school be a 5th-6th grade building, and the other school be a 7th-8th grade building. I would like to make a motion to give the Superintendent some time to look at that, put a team together, look at contracts, to see if we can move our district forward in that manner.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I didn't present the 5-6/7-8 model. Because of our enrollment now, at the Andrews and McGlynn we're looking at 1000 students. By adding the 5th grade it would put us at a little over 1300 students, which would put 650 students in each building. It would force us to confront a capacity challenge for the size of the buildings. I'm still willing to look at other options. From a physical plant capacity issue, we may hit the limit for the size of the buildings.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Superintendent, I appreciate your fair and equitable approach to this dilemma. However, I believe it will still cause consternation. In the past the McGlynn Elementary students had the option to stay at the McGlynn if they wanted. In this case, half would go to the Andrews?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - There would be the option at the McGlynn for reverse sibling preference for parents. However, for fairness, we are going to honor the lottery cohort model for all students unless parents prefer to keep siblings together. If we're going to do it for one, do it for all and do it fairly.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Sibling preference - parents would argue they had sibling preference the year after their child moved out of the school. As we roll this out, we should be clear on this.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - My recommendation would be that the sibling preference would only be for a student that is enrolled. The idea is for convenience for parents. Mayor Burke - There was a school committee vote affirming that in a prior year. Ms. Van der Kloot - How do you sell this to the greater community? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I believe this is the fairer way. There is a perception gap about the two middle schools. Being at the schools, children are learning. We have high quality teachers across the district. No matter what school your child goes to, they will get a quality education.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Friendship groups? Can we foster activities or create opportunities for students to meet each other as we enter this new phase? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Speaking to parents, some students ended up not having even one friend now. If you do 50/50 you are more likely to have at least a few friends. We are one district. I hope the parents understand that their children are getting a quality education.

Mr. Ruggiero - Will students be able to do after school programs at the other middle school? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - There are enrichment activities three days a week. None of that would have to change. Mr. Ruggiero - Are there still programmatic issues? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - If students have a specialized program, they would be assigned to the appropriate school. That would remain the same. Mr. Ruggiero - I think this is the fairest option to avoid economic disparities. I would like to review materials in a Committee of the Whole. Ms. Kreatz - We have always had school choice. I think students look forward to that. They may not get that opportunity. I think it's a great way to keep everything unbiased, but it's a difficult time to move from elementary school to middle school. I wasn't expecting this. I am concerned and unsure what the new process will be. How will the public take it. We are taking away their choice. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The final decision will be of the School Committee. But the current system in place is segregated and we should call it what it is. When you look at the tables, the schools are divided out in a particular way. And if you continue with choice you are endorsing segregation. It's hard, it's 2019, this is Medford, but the current system is a segregated system. I am fine with a Committee of the Whole. Mr. Ruseau - I want to refresh our memories of last week when we heard that 60 of the McGlynn students are going on a trip and 130 of the Andrews students are going on the trip. I couldn't support this more.

Ms. Opara - I did not go through the Medford public middle school system, but I babysat a student who went through the elementary school and they talked about going to the middle school. One friend is going to one school and one is going to another. I didn't understand how that was split up. I went to a charter school and since coming to Medford High I understand why

people might not like charters. It is unfair that people get different chances. A selected core group of students being in one place, there are disparities, the field trip numbers, etc. There may not be an underlying problem but it is a segregated system. I think it should be addressed. Medford calls out charter schools, but if there are disparities like this, it doesn't make sense. Being with different people gives you the opportunity to learn and grow together. People shouldn't feel they're not good enough because of what school they attend.

Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to remind people that when the new schools were built, part of the request to build new schools was based on diversity in those buildings. Mayor Burke - Racial balance plan, yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - We don't receive federal funding for that anymore, but we may have lost sight of that along the way. It used to be the McGlynn was the school to go to, then the Andrews, it goes back and forth. We have never looked at it so deeply. If we do good outreach we can help parents adjust to the idea. Change is always hard. Ms. Van der Kloot - Earlier tonight in Committee of the Whole we said we are here for all students, to make sure their educational opportunities are best for them. If I look at that guiding principle, I appreciate that my colleague may want some more time to digest and talk about rollout. On the other hand I would like to affirm the policy and say it should move forward, then have a sub committee meeting to talk about how to do it. I am trying to think of the right rules of order.

Mr. Ruggiero - The system we have now is not working. My concern is that there's another option to consider. A magnet school for math/science and a magnet school for humanities. Mayor Burke - For September? That would take a long time. Mr. Ruggiero - These are options, I just want to make sure we are making the right choice. I share the Superintendent's concerns. I want to make sure we are exploring all the options. Ms. Mustone - I think the lottery is long overdue. It might be painful. But this is about justice. We've never bitten the bullet before. We have never followed school choice by pure definition. I have been frustrated by this.

Motion to have a Committee of the Whole to discuss the steps to implementation offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Can we change the Committee of the Whole to discuss the rollout?

Melanie McLaughlin - I have had three children at the Brooks Elementary School, two students who went through the different middle schools. The data tells a story and speaks for itself. We were looking at the data in the audience. It tells an important story of a segregated system. I understand programmatic elements and budgeting concerns, but all means all. Special education programs and students should be evenly distributed in both middle schools.

Ms. Opara - Mr. D'Alleva and I have been discussing the issue of enclaves at the high school. It can begin in the middle schools through lack of exposure and gets worse in the high schools. To combat this issue we should be addressing it earlier.

Mr. Ruseau - The issue of all meaning all is very important and why I think the 5-6/7-8 concept is important. I think we should see what our options are about getting all our students together as early as possible. It solves a lot of problems for EL and everybody being in one place, the services issue would solve itself. It would be good to see a number of what it would be to resolve that. A projection. Can we do the lottery earlier? Before Open Houses? Ms. Van der Kloot - The in-depth study of the 5-6/7-8 would be useful, but I don't think we can answer every question before next year. Mr. Ruseau - I fully support this, but the economically disadvantaged students we are trying to level out, they also all need to experience students with autism, all kids, kids who don't speak English, and they're not. I think that point is important.

Mr. Ruggiero - There are some questions up in the air. Programmatic switches. I have complete faith in the Superintendent, but I don't think delaying this for a short time to have a Committee of the Whole will destroy the idea. Once we answer our questions I think we will agree that this is the best thing for Medford but that we need more time.

Mr. D'Alleva - Former Principal of the Andrews Middle School. For the open houses, if nothing is changing they will be the same. If it is changing it will be like an orientation. Time is of the essence. From a scheduling standpoint, the imbalance is tough. Trying to get everybody what they want, the number inequity sometimes can be a problem.

Motion to delay approval of the Superintendent's Cohort 50/50 model proposal until the committee can meet in Committee of the Whole offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll call vote:

2 - Affirmative

Mr. Ruggiero

Ms. Kreatz

5 - Negative

Mr. Ruseau

Ms. Van der Kloot

Ms. Mustone

Ms. DiBenedetto

Mayor Burke

Motion fails

Motion to approve policy change followed by committee of the whole to determine the rollout offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau.

Roll call vote:

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes

Motion that sibling preference is for children in the same school at the same time offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau.

Roll call vote:

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes

Report on UDL Emergency Preparedness Committee - Ms. Medaglio and Ms. McLaughlin - We started this committee last year and have been meeting for a year and a half. Initially it was about special education students, but we realized it should really be for emergency preparedness for any person who would be in our buildings. Best practices recommend you keep in mind students with disabilities but with no specifics. Members of the committee are here, we meet monthly to discuss our research. We looked at involving community stakeholders. Create individualized emergency tool kits for students with disabilities. This is an ongoing process for adults in the building as well. Anyone can injure themselves and require extra support during an emergency. All facets of the community should be working together. Many emergency preparedness opportunities funded through Homeland Security. It's an untapped resource. Communicate emergency preparedness plans to students with disabilities and families on an annual basis. Convene a district-wide emergency preparedness committee. It needs to be school, fire, and police all represented in the conversation. NPR story, "Medford Schools Working to Improve Emergency Plans for Students with Disabilities." This is an opportunity for Medford to be a leader in the state on this issue.

Mr. Ruggiero - Thank you for this presentation. Superintendent do we have a district wide committee on emergency preparedness yet? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - No. We could look into it. Motion to convene a district-wide committee on emergency preparedness offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Mr. Ruseau - You found that some Gen Ed students needed a plan as well, do you have an idea about how to do that? Ms. McLaughlin - The great thing about looking at disability is that you

help everyone in the process. Ms. DiBenedetto - I would suggest that you include people with disabilities in the meetings. Ms. Medaglio - We have been talking about that, including self-advocates.

Motion to move Negotiations and Legal Matters to the end offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Condolences - see agenda.

Motion to move to Executive Session offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Regular meeting ended at 9:27pm.

School Committee entered executive session. Executive session ended at 10:05pm.